

Social media is widely used in daily life, especially by young people. Many children use social media to watch videos and follow some famous people. They also see many food advertisements online, especially fast food and sugary products. These advertisements can affect what children like to eat. As a result, social media can influence children's eating habits, especially in Saudi Arabia where its use is very common.

According to Gue (2023), who conducted a systematic review and meta-analysis examining the impact of unhealthy food marketing on children through social media, the study found that it boosts children's preference for unhealthy food.

According to Smith et al (2018), social media advertisements boost children's preference for high fat and sugary foods.

According to Alanazi et al (2023), high use of social media is linked to increased consumption among children. And there is a relationship between Social Media use and unhealthy dietary habits.

Currently, many children in Saudi Arabia spend a lot of time on social media and are exposed to unhealthy food advertisements, which can lead to unhealthy eating habits. Ideally, social media should be used to promote healthy eating habits and help children make better food choices. Therefore, parents should monitor their children's use of social media and guide them to choose healthy food as well as educate them about healthy eating habits.

(Research Questions)

- 1- What are the effects of social media on Saudi children's food habits?
- 2- Why do children rely on social media about their food habits?
- 3- How can parents eliminate the negative effects of social media on their kids?